

Sara Mannan, MPH

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User Experience Researcher with 6+ years of experience driving user-centered insights across federal, healthcare, and nonprofit sectors. Skilled in mixed-methods research, usability testing, and translating complex data into actionable product and design recommendations. Proven track record of influencing stakeholders and improving digital experiences through evidence-based decision-making.

Core Skills

UX Research Methods: Usability testing, material testing, cognitive interviews, card sorting, heuristic evaluations, surveys, A/B testing, journey mapping, in-depth interviews

Research Strategy: Study design, research planning, stakeholder workshops, insight generation and synthesis

Tools: ChatGPT, Claude, Qualtrics, NVivo, Atlassian, Excel, R, Stata, SurveyMonkey, Optimal Workshop, Miro, Asana, Jira, Figma

Communication: Storytelling, reporting, cross-functional collaboration

Experience

CommunicateHealth – UX Researcher (2024-2025)

- Designed and executed end-to-end UX research studies for clients including the U.S. Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion (ODPHP), American Medical Association, and Eli Lilly, using mixed methods such as usability testing, interviews, and surveys
- Developed moderator guides, screeners, and research protocols to ensure consistent, high-quality data collection across studies
- Moderated user interviews and usability sessions, uncovering key usability issues, behavioral patterns, and unmet user needs
- Collaborated directly with clients and cross-functional teams to implement research-driven changes and iterate on digital experiences
- Ensured human subjects compliance (IRB, OMB); CITI-certified.

Fors Marsh (2021-2024)

UX Researcher

- Led end-to-end UX research studies for federal and commercial clients (NIH, SSA, IRS, Meta), using usability testing, interviews, and heuristic evaluations.
- Designed and facilitated usability testing sessions and synthesized findings into actionable recommendations.
- Led a website usability study of forsmarsh.com and facilitated insights workshops with 20+ stakeholders.
- Analyzed qualitative data using NVivo and presented insights to cross-functional teams.

Research Analyst II

- Produced weekly COVID-19 research reports analyzing public sentiment and behavioral trends.
- Developed surveys and focus group protocols to inform national public health campaigns.
- Synthesized data into strategic recommendations supporting the “We Can Do This” campaign.

Harvard Pilgrim Health Care Institute — Project Coordinator (2020-2021)

- Managed FDA-funded research projects and coordinated cross-functional teams.
- Maintained project tracking systems using Atlassian tools.

- Improved internal documentation through collaboration with SMEs and users.

Brigham and Women's Hospital — Research Associate (2019–2020)

- Conducted quantitative analysis using R for maternal health research.
- Designed and deployed surveys and analyzed mixed-methods data.

Professional Development

- Nielsen Norman Group | UX Certifications (Usability Testing, UX Basics, Information Architecture)
- General Assembly | Data Analysis Circuit

Education

Masters in Public Health - Epidemiology and Biostatistics & Global Health
Boston University
Graduated: 2020

Bachelors in Health Administration and Public Policy
University of Maryland, Baltimore County
Graduated: 2017

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. Rajbhandari, R., Blakemore, S., Gupta, N., Adler, A. J., Noble, C. A., Mannan, S., Nikolli, K., Yih, A., Joshi, S., & Bukhman, G. (2020). Crohn's disease in low and lower-middle income countries: A scoping review. *World journal of gastroenterology*, <https://doi.org/10.3748/wjg.v26.i43.6891>
2. Rajbhandari, R., Blakemore, S.; Gupta, N., Mannan, S., Nikolli, K., Yih, A.,; Drown, L., Bukhman, G.; Crohn's Disease Among the Poorest Billion: Survey Data From Low and Lower Middle-Income Countries, *The American Journal of Gastroenterology*: October 2020 - Volume 115-
<https://doi.org/10.14309/01.ajg.0000705388.74031.75>
3. Soofi SB, Vadsaria K, Mannan S, Habib MA, Tabassum F, Hussain I, Muhammad S, Feroz K, Ahmed I, Islam M, et al. Factors Associated with Vaccine Refusal (Polio and Routine Immunization) in High-Risk Areas of Pakistan: A Matched Case-Control Study. *Vaccines*. 2023; 11(5):947. <https://doi.org/10.3390/vaccines11050947>

Poster Presentations

1. Mannan S, McNulty J. *In Users We Trust*. Poster presented at: American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR); 2023 May 10-12; Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.